

Remote and Hybrid Working Policy

Version 3.2 | Owner: People Operations | Effective 2026-01-01 | Next review 2027-01-01

1. Purpose and principle

Zuqah Technologies is a hybrid organisation. Where you work is decided by what the work needs, not by a fixed rule applied uniformly.

The principle throughout: be where the work is best done. Some weeks that is a client site every day; some weeks it is entirely from home.

2. Working patterns

Pattern	Expectation	Who
Hybrid	2 days per week in an office or at a client site, averaged monthly	Default for most roles
Client-based	As the engagement requires	Consultants on client-site engagements
Fully remote	No regular office attendance	By agreement, see section 3

The hybrid expectation is averaged over a month rather than enforced weekly. A week entirely at home followed by a week entirely on site meets it.

Attendance is not tracked by badge data, and managers are asked not to use badge data for this purpose.

3. Fully remote arrangements

A fully remote arrangement is agreed between the employee, their manager and People Operations. It is documented and reviewed annually.

Fully remote employees receive:

- A home internet contribution of \$40 per month, claimed through expenses
- A one-off home office allowance of \$500 for desk, chair and lighting
- Travel and accommodation covered when asked to attend an office or client site

The home office allowance is claimed once per employee, not annually. Equipment bought with it belongs to the employee, unlike Zuqah Technologies IT equipment.

4. Working from another location

4.1 Within your country of employment

No approval needed. Tell your manager where you will be if it affects your hours.

4.2 Another country, up to 10 working days

Notify People Operations before travelling. Approval is normally granted; the notification exists because short stays can still create tax obligations in some countries.

Note that VPN access is blocked from countries outside the approved list. Request temporary access at least five business days before departure — see the Remote Access and VPN Policy, section 8.

4.3 Another country, more than 10 working days

Requires approval from People Operations and review by Finance, at least six weeks in advance. Longer stays can create permanent establishment risk, personal tax liability and immigration issues.

Approval is sometimes declined for reasons that have nothing to do with the individual or their performance. Where that happens, the reason is explained.

5. Working hours

Zuqah Technologies does not set fixed hours. The expectations are:

- Be reachable during your team's agreed core hours, typically 10:00 to 16:00

local time

- Meet client commitments, which may require specific hours
- Keep your calendar accurate — it is the primary signal of availability

Working outside core hours to suit personal circumstances is fine and does not need approval.

Consistently working outside them in a way that isolates you from your team is a conversation to have with your manager, not a rule being broken.

6. Time zones

Where a team spans time zones, meetings should rotate rather than consistently inconveniencing the same people. Anything that could be a written update should be one.

7. Office space

Offices are bookable through the workplace portal. Desks are not assigned. Book at least a day ahead where possible; capacity is a genuine constraint on Tuesdays and Wednesdays.

8. Health, safety and equipment

Employees are responsible for a safe home working environment. People Operations provides a self-assessment checklist, completed on joining and reviewed annually.

Home working equipment beyond the allowance in section 3 — specifically equipment needed for an accessibility or occupational health reason — is provided by Zuqah Technologies and is outside the allowance. Requests go to People Operations. See also the Printing and Peripherals Guide, section 6.

9. When this policy does not apply

Where a client engagement specifies attendance requirements, those requirements apply for the duration of the engagement. Where local employment law provides more than this policy, local law applies.

this document describes no real organisation's policy.*

Sample content for demonstration purposes. Zuqah Technologies is a fictional company and this document describes no real organisation's policy.